

of the captains of Indian and global industry: from N Chandrasekaran, chairman of Tata Sons and the B20 India Chair; to Shantanu Narayen, Chair and CEO of Adobe; Arvind Krishna, Chairman and CEO of IBM; and, Sunil Bharti Mittal, Chairman of Bharti Enterprises.

All this is expected to translate into trade and investment opportunities for Indian businesses that will also help with global expansion. Besides, it could also give domestic industry a prominent seat at the table not just in international trade, but also in discussions on policy matters like trade agreements. It may also give Indian firms a bigger say in issues like climate change.

STEPPING STONE

Godrej calls this “merely a stepping stone” for bigger benefits that will follow. “[The] China+1 [strategy] is only one part to it. As a country, a lot of work has been done on developmental R&D (research and development) and we will now need to focus our attention on the fundamental part,” he says. To his mind, the digital stack has been a big breakthrough for India and one that can be taken to the rest of the world. “The G20 comes when India is at an interesting stage of development and better off than most countries, including China,” says Godrej.

For a long time, China has had

THE PROMISE

1 G20 represents 85 per cent of global GDP and 75 per cent of trade, making India's presidency critical

2 After liberalisation of the economy in 1991, this could be the next big moment for India

3 In less than a decade, India has become the fifth largest economy from the tenth largest one

4 The G20 has allowed India's best minds to work closely with their global counterparts

5 A more favourable disposition towards India could give it a greater say in matters of international trade

a huge advantage in manufacturing at scale backed largely by low labour costs. “If labour-intensive manufacturing worked for them, we can make a mark in knowledge-intensive manufacturing.” In an industry like chemicals, some manufacturing has moved to the US. “If we can build on that, what we don't have by way of labour can be made up through our prowess in technology. This is also where PLIs will make a difference,” says Godrej.

A lot of progress has already been made. Pai highlights how India has forged a consensus on developing an international reference for classifying occupations to promote cross-country comparability under the G20 Employment Working Group. “The G20 members have also pledged to provide adequate social protection for all workers, including gig and platform workers, which will help such workers tide over stresses across the life cycle. In India alone, 7.7 million gig and platform workers are set to benefit from this,” he says. The Indian presidency has launched the Startup20 engagement group to help boost that segment.

In the near- to long term, there will be an impact, profound in all likelihood, on various sectors. As this big moment draws closer, we take a look at how different sectors of Indian industry are gauging the G20 platform's impact. Read on. **BT**

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“India's G20 presidency is well-timed for it to exercise greater influence on the agenda and narrative on global policies across economic, social, environmental, and digital sectors. This is when we are the fastest-growing large economy”

AJIT PAI

PARTNER (GOVERNMENT AND PUBLIC SECTOR), EY INDIA